

G05 — The Passive Voice

La voix passive



S3 — Cours 2



B1



marc.vasseur@polytech-lille.fr

🔴 La voix passive est omniprésente en anglais scientifique et technique. Elle permet de mettre en avant le résultat plutôt que l'acteur.

1. Formation — BE + Participe Passé

Structure	Anglais	Note
Formule	Subject + BE (au bon temps) + Past Participle + (by + agent)	L'agent est optionnel et souvent omis.

TEMPS ACTIF	PASSIF	EXEMPLE
Present Simple	am/is/are + PP	The report is written every week.
Past Simple	was/were + PP	The bridge was built in 1990.
Present Continuous	am/is/are being + PP	The machine is being repaired.
Past Continuous	was/were being + PP	The car was being tested when it failed.
Present Perfect	have/has been + PP	The data has been collected.
Past Perfect	had been + PP	The form had been submitted before the deadline.
Future (will)	will be + PP	The results will be published.
Future (going to)	am/is/are going to be + PP	It is going to be fixed tomorrow.
Modal verbs	modal + be + PP	The problem can be solved.

2. Quand utiliser le passif ?

- ✓ L'agent est inconnu : My bike was stolen.
- ✓ L'agent est évident ou sans intérêt : He was arrested. (by police = évident)
- ✓ Style scientifique/technique : The experiment was conducted under controlled conditions.
- ✓ Pour valoriser le résultat : This molecule was discovered by Dr. Smith.

3. Transformation Actif → Passif

1. L'OBJET de l'actif devient le SUJET du passif
 2. Le verbe → BE (au bon temps) + participe passé
 3. Le SUJET de l'actif → (by + agent) — optionnel
- EXEMPLE : The engineers (S) designed (V) the bridge (O). [actif]

→ PASSIF : The bridge (S) was designed (PP) by the engineers (agent).

⚠ Verbes à 2 objets (give, tell, send, show...) : les deux objets peuvent devenir sujet du passif.

🧠 PASSIF = mettre l'objet de l'action en avant. Très courant en anglais scientifique : 'The results were analysed...'



EXERCICES GUIDÉS

Transforme à la voix passive en suivant les indices.

Série guidée A — Passif aux temps de base

💡 O (actif) → S (passif) / V → BE + PP / S (actif) → by + agent (optionnel)

1. They repair the machines every month. → The machines _____.
→ Présent Simple passif
→ _____
2. Someone stole her laptop. → Her laptop _____.
→ Past Simple passif
→ _____
3. They are building a new highway. → A new highway _____.
→ Continuous passif
→ _____
4. Scientists have discovered a new element. → A new element _____.
→ Perfect passif
→ _____
5. They will publish the results next week. → The results _____.
→ Future passif
→ _____
6. A technician was checking the equipment. → The equipment _____.
→ Past Continuous passif
→ _____
7. They had submitted the form before the deadline. → The form _____.
→ Past Perfect passif
→ _____
8. We are going to launch the product in January. → The product _____.
→ Going to passif
→ _____
9. Someone can solve this problem. → This problem _____.
→ Modal passif
→ _____
10. We must submit the report by Friday. → The report _____.
→ Modal passif
→ _____

Série guidée B — Passif avec modaux et cas complexes

💡 Verbes à double objet : les deux objets peuvent passer en sujet

11. They should test the software before launch. → The software _____.

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→ should + be + tested

→ _____

12. The company might delay the project. → The project _____.

→ might + be + delayed

→ _____

13. They had to cancel the experiment. → The experiment _____.

→ had to + be + cancelled

→ _____

14. She told me the results. (2 obj.) → I _____ / The results _____.

→ 2 passifs possibles

→ _____

15. They sent her a new contract. → She _____ / A new contract _____.

→ 2 passifs possibles

→ _____

16. The manager will give us the feedback. → We _____ / The feedback _____.

→ 2 passifs possibles

→ _____

17. We need to verify all the data. → All the data _____.

→ need to be + PP

→ _____

18. They ought to redesign the interface. → The interface _____.

→ ought to be + PP

→ _____

19. Nobody has signed the document yet. → The document _____.

→ PP + yet

→ _____

20. Someone is going to assess the risks. → The risks _____.

→ going to be + PP

→ _____

EXERCICES — NIVEAUX A → B2+

Mets à la voix passive.

Niveau A — Transformations de base (B1)

1. The technician checks the equipment every day.
→ _____
2. Someone broke the window last night.
→ _____
3. They are testing the new software.
→ _____
4. Scientists have confirmed the results.
→ _____
5. The company will announce the merger tomorrow.
→ _____
6. They can solve this problem easily.
→ _____
7. The workers had built the bridge before 2010.
→ _____
8. Someone is reading your email right now.
→ _____
9. We must complete the analysis by Monday.
→ _____
10. They have just delivered the prototype.
→ _____

Niveau B — Contexte professionnel (B1+)

11. The professor explained the theory clearly.
→ _____
12. Engineers are developing new AI tools.
→ _____
13. They should update the software regularly.
→ _____
14. We had finished the report before the meeting.
→ _____
15. The committee will review all applications.
→ _____
16. Someone has corrected all the mistakes.
→ _____
17. The manager signed the contract yesterday.
→ _____
18. They might postpone the deadline.
→ _____
19. The lab is running three simultaneous experiments.
→ _____
20. We need to verify all the data before submission.
→ _____

→ _____

Niveau C — Passif → Actif + Correction d'erreurs (B1+)

→ Transforme ces phrases passives en phrases actives.

21. The report was written by the senior engineer.

→ _____

22. The samples have been analysed by the laboratory.

→ _____

23. New regulations will be introduced by the government.

→ _____

24. The machine is being repaired by a technician.

→ _____

25. The error had been detected by the system before we arrived.

→ _____

→ Corrige les erreurs dans ces phrases passives.

26. The report is wrote by the team every month. → _____

→ _____

27. The machine was been repaired last week. → _____

→ _____

28. The results will published next week. → _____

→ _____

29. The system is being check by engineers. → _____

→ _____

30. It have been decided to postpone the launch. → _____

→ _____

Niveau D — Style scientifique et complexité B2+

→ Reformule ce texte scientifique en utilisant la voix passive au maximum.

31. We collected the samples from three different sites. → _____

→ _____

32. The team analysed them using spectroscopy. → _____

→ _____

33. Researchers have recently published the findings in Nature. → _____

→ _____

34. They will conduct a second study to confirm the results. → _____

→ _____

35. The peer review process validated the methodology. → _____

→ _____

→ Traduire en anglais en utilisant le passif.

36. Les données ont été recueillies sur une période de six mois.

→ _____

37. Le prototype est actuellement testé dans des conditions réelles.

→ _____

38. Cette technique a été mise au point par une équipe de l'INRIA.

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→ _____

39. Les résultats devront être vérifiés avant publication.

→ _____

40. Des mesures supplémentaires auraient dû être prises plus tôt.

→ _____

Score : _____ / 40 points

★ ★ Bonus — Passif causatif et registre

Dans quel contexte préférerait-on l'actif ou le passif ? Justifie et transforme si nécessaire.

→ 'Researchers found a new treatment.' vs 'A new treatment was found.' — style scientifique ?

Réponse : _____

→ 'We apologise for the delay.' — Peut-on mettre ça au passif ? Pourquoi ?

Réponse : _____

→ Rédige 3 phrases de compte-rendu de TP au passif.

Réponse : _____

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DEVOIR MAISON

Nom & Prénom : _____

Groupe : _____

Date rendu : _____



Mets à la voix passive.



Correction envoyée via WhatsApp la semaine prochaine.

1. They test the equipment every six months.

→ _____

2. Someone had already fixed the problem when we arrived.

→ _____

3. The team is analysing the data right now.

→ _____

4. They should publish the findings as soon as possible.

→ _____

5. She has written three full reports this month.

→ _____

6. We will review the proposal next week.

→ _____

7. The manager approved the budget yesterday morning.

→ _____

8. They might cancel the project due to budget cuts.

→ _____

9. Someone must check all the results before submission.

→ _____

10. They are currently building a new research laboratory.

→ _____

11. The engineer had designed the system before the merger.

→ _____

12. We ought to reconsider the approach.

→ _____

13. Chemists discovered this compound in the 1980s.

→ _____

14. The professor is going to explain the experiment tomorrow.

→ _____

15. The committee may approve new regulations next month.

→ _____

Score : _____ / 15 points